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An account of the Zande

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Sudan, Democratic Republic of the Congo, and Central African Republic

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[JMA: The following is derived from one informant and 'should be accepted with reserve']

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[Ethnometeorology](#)

"At first, there was darkness in the world, and then Mbali created light. Light exists as a distinct phenomenon. It is not produced by the agency of sun or moon....

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Every day there is a new sun. Where that of to-day goes at sunset, nobody knows. If it suddenly returned in its course from the west to the east, the land would be destroyed....

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An evening star, called Tungu, is said to be the moon's wife. A Zande, questioned on this point, replied 'Yes, we call Tungu the moon's [43] wife, because they are seen in close proximity to each other, but it is only a joke. It is not its wife really.'....

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Meteorites are mongua gumba, axes of the thunder, because they are produced by thunder and have the appearance of a Zande axe.

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Comets and eclipses are presages of misfortune....

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Thunder has been described as visiting the earth either as a great bird or in the form of a squirrel, which runs along the branches of a tree with fire in its tail and bearing a little axe in its mouth with which it splits the wood."

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